

INDEPENDENT CONTRACTOR AGREEMENT

Kestrel Dynamics LLC • August 2026

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This Independent Contractor Agreement (the "Agreement") is made effective as of August 20, 2026, by and between Kestrel Dynamics LLC ("Client") and Marcus V. Sterling ("Contractor").

- Services:** Contractor agrees to provide freelance graphic design and branding services to the Client, specifically focusing on the redesign of the Client's primary marketing website and logo suite (the "Services").
- Compensation:** In consideration for the Services, Client shall pay Contractor a flat fee of \$12,500. A non-refundable deposit of \$4,000 is due upon execution of this Agreement, with the remaining balance payable net-30 days following the final delivery and acceptance of all design assets.
- Independent Contractor Status:** Contractor is an independent contractor, not an employee, agent, or partner of the Client. Contractor shall be solely responsible for the payment of all federal, state, and local income taxes, social security taxes, and unemployment taxes arising from the compensation paid under this Agreement. Contractor is not entitled to any benefits, including but not limited to health insurance, paid time off, or retirement contributions.
- Intellectual Property:** Upon receipt of full payment, Contractor hereby assigns and transfers to Client all right, title, and interest in and to all deliverables, designs, and work product created under this Agreement. Contractor retains the right to display the finalized work in their professional portfolio for promotional purposes only.
- Termination:** Either party may terminate this Agreement with fourteen (14) days' written notice. In the event of early termination, Contractor shall be compensated for all work satisfactorily completed prior to the termination date. Upon termination, Contractor must return all Client materials and proprietary data.